

STEFANUS FOUKARIDIS

Principal Full-Stack Engineer

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Professional Summary

Dynamic Principal Full-Stack Engineer with 18+ years of extensive experience in architecting and delivering innovative solutions across various industries, including fintech, education, telecoms and cloud-based applications. Demonstrates profound expertise in full-stack development, project management, and DevOps practices, effectively driving technical initiatives from conception to deployment. Skilled in leveraging advanced technologies such as GoLang and Google Cloud Platform to create secure, scalable infrastructures and optimize operational efficiencies. Committed to fostering team development through mentorship and establishing best practices, ensuring high-quality delivery in all projects.

Core Competencies

Programming Languages

GoLang • PHP • Python • C# • NodeJS
• JavaScript • VoiceXML...

Frameworks & Libraries

Laravel • Django • React • .NET...

Cloud & Infrastructure

Google Cloud Platform • Digital Ocean
• Docker • Cloud Run • Firebase • Build
Triggers...

Databases

MySQL • MSSQL • PostgreSQL •
Interbase • Firebird • CloudSQL •
Firebase • NoSQL...

Development Practices

Agile • Waterfall • Test Driven
Development • DevOps • GIT...

Design & Analysis

Enterprise Architect • Business
Analysis • Data Modelling •
Normalisation ...

Professional Experience

Full-Stack Solution Architect + Project Manager + DevOps Engineer

Experttech (Contract)

October 2024 – December 2025

Engaged by Experttech to architect and develop a cloud-based Job Profiling solution for SITA, featuring comprehensive security and role-based access control. Designed and implemented a scalable architecture using Google Cloud Platform with CloudSQL relational database, secured by OAuth2 authentication and dynamic GoLang API services.

Key Achievements

- Architected secure, scalable cloud infrastructure with automated CRUD operations
- Developed dynamic GoLang API that automatically generates handlers based on database schema analysis
- Implemented comprehensive role-based access control system with OAuth2 integration
- Successfully delivered end-to-end solution spanning business analysis through deployment

Technical Leadership Roles

- Business Analyst: Requirements gathering, JAD sessions, scope definition
- System Designer: High-level architecture decisions and technical strategy
- Database Developer: Schema design, query optimization, data management
- Project Manager: Timeline creation, task management, delivery coordination
- Cloud Administrator: Infrastructure setup, deployment management, security implementation
- Full-Stack Developer: API development (GoLang), front-end implementation (ReactJS), UI/UX design

Technologies

Go-Lang, GCP, ReactJS, Auth0

Principal Full-Stack Engineer

Principals' Choice

March 2022 – September 2024

Led technical initiatives across multiple high-impact projects, primarily focusing on fintech solutions for Celbux, a virtual wallet and finance company. Designed and developed critical integrations with business partners including Flash, creating cash-out systems for sports betting platforms.

Key Achievements

- Architected and delivered support tools with direct API integrations
- Developed partner integration systems processing high-volume financial transactions
- Built comprehensive internal administrative tools improving operational efficiency
- Established robust DevOps processes and development workflows

Core Responsibilities

- Solution architecture and technical design leadership
- Template development and code standardization for junior developers
- Technical mentoring and team development
- DevOps process optimization and environment management
- Google Cloud Platform solutions design and implementation
- Additional development of C# Payment System

Technologies

Go-Lang, GCP, PHP, Wordpress, .NET, C#, ReactJS

Principal Full-Stack Engineer

Freelance: Various Clients

February 2021 – February 2022

Developed solutions for clients such as Sun Oil, Pocketime, Massmart & Builders. Solutions ranged from WordPress sites and integrations to a CRM with geolocation tracking and lead management using PHP and Laravel.

Key Achievements

- SellMe Sales Rep CRM (PHP, Laravel, Geolocation, Google Maps API):
 - Designed and built a custom Laravel CRM to manage the full sales pipeline from lead to contract
 - Solved client's integrity challenge by implementing mandatory Google Maps geolocation check-ins when logging sales meetings
- Builders "Big Idea" Portal (Wordpress, CustomPHP, Responsive Design, Plugin Development):
 - Built a complete idea submission, voting, and moderation plugin from scratch
 - Designed the database and responsive interface to foster engagement
 - Provided ongoing maintenance via an SLA.
- Massmart GoFetch API Integration (Wordpress, APIs, PHP, CMS Development):
 - Integrated a WordPress employee portal with Massmart's enterprise GoFetch CMS API
 - Developed custom PHP plugins for secure authentication and bidirectional data synchronization, automating user management for 1000+ employees and enabling personalized content delivery based on live HR data.

Technologies

PHP, Laravel, Wordpress, Agile Development, C#, MySQL, .NET

Senior Software Developer

d6 Group

October 2017 – August 2021

Returned to hands-on development within the educational technology sector, working alongside a high-caliber team of senior developers. Contributed across multiple product lines including d6 Connect API and d6+ platform enhancements.

Key Contributions & Core Responsibilities

- API development and maintenance for d6 Connect platform
- Legacy system modernization and code optimization for d6+
- New feature development and system architecture improvements
- Cross-functional collaboration on educational technology solutions
- Developed and maintained public-facing REST APIs for the d6 Connect platform, serving educational institutions.
- Modernized legacy codebase for the d6+ platform, improving performance, maintainability, and scalability.
- Collaborated in a high-caliber senior team on system architecture, new feature development, and cross-functional product strategy.
- Gained deep experience in the full SaaS product lifecycle within a structured, agile development environment.
- Maintained C# Data Conversion Tools

Technologies

PHP, Laravel, REST API Development, SaaS, System Modernization, Agile Development, C#, MySQL, GCP, .NET

Senior Team Leader

Parallel Software

May 2016 – September 2017

Promoted to lead the technical team, responsible for strategic technology decisions, team development, and hands-on technical delivery, often meeting with clients to determine their business requirements and formulate a fitting solution.

Leadership Achievements

- Built and mentored high-performing development team
- Implemented comprehensive training programs and professional development initiatives
- Established industry-standard development methodologies and best practices
- Led technology stack evaluation and architectural decisions

- Facilitated synergy between departments

Technologies

PHP, SOAP API Development, MySQL, AWS, Python, [Node.js](#), Docker, NGinx

Senior Systems Developer

Parallel Software

August 2014 – May 2016

Maintained and enhanced the Placement Partner platform while developing custom client solutions. Expanded responsibilities to include system administration and API development using emerging technologies.

Technologies

PHP, SOAP API Development, MySQL, AWS, Python, [Node.js](#), Docker, NGinx

Senior Developer

Freelance: VD Sys, Various

February 2011 – July 2014

Provided specialized development services with primary focus on security applications for VidiSys. Delivered high-quality solutions across multiple platforms and technologies including real-time alert systems, IP tracker and CSRF token protection.

Technologies

C++, Posix, Websockets, PHP, MySQL, LibPCap, MaxMind GeoIP

System Designer / Senior Developer

Aspivia

December 2009 – February 2011

Collaborated on the Ti2 System development in a distributed team environment, working alongside international developers. Contributed to both new system development and legacy system maintenance.

Achievements

- Completed Ti2
- Sharded a very large CDIR database over 2 servers using ods and evens and rewrote all the relevant code
- Championed improved development planning, documentation and processes

Technologies

PHP, MySQL, Perl

Senior Developer / Development Lead

Fujitsu

December 2008 – November 2009

Led development team for Western Cape Department of Education project, combining business analysis with technical leadership. Managed stakeholder relationships and guided technical implementation including system mockups, prototyping, and requirements refinement.

Achievements

- Was promoted to Development Lead due to having put in the time and effort to fully understand the business requirements & design
- Recreated 6 months of BRS in 2 weeks
- Mentored and taught the juniors by creating sample templates for them and tutoring them re. PHP, Databases, Asynchronous architectures, etc

Technologies

PHP, MySQL, Oracle, Java

Developer

Sisha.com Systems

May 2008 – December 2008

Single-handedly developed comprehensive business automation solutions across multiple technologies and platforms. Delivered critical system integrations and database migrations.

Achievements

- Created server monitoring software with SMS notifications and remote management options for Sisha.com's Fax2Email servers
- Developed a database cloner that would copy an Interbase DB over to MSSQL

Technologies

C, C++, PHP

Developer

Neametrics

April 2008 – May 2008

Developed an MMS gateway for ProofTag authentication system and preliminary code to decode PDF417 barcodes for the Namibian Licence Department's Learner Licences.

Technologies

Visual C++, IIS

Junior Developer

Safikatel / NGN

April 2007 – April 2008

Developed and maintained interactive voice response systems for high-profile clients including MNET Idols and Big Brother SA voting systems, TrafficNet interactive traffic information system, Phumelela Horsebetting IVR as well as co-developed the first in-house Fax2Email server in South Africa.

Achievements

- Taught myself IBM Websphere & AIX servers over a sleepless weekend
- Was one of two juniors to develop the first in-house Fax2Email server in South Africa: we received a DIVA card from abroad and had Inbound and Outbound faxing built in 2 weeks.

Technologies

C, C++, Websphere State Tables & Custom Servers, VoiceXML, PHP

Education & Certifications

Google Cloud Developer - GCP Professional Certification

Udemy

2023

Certified Ethical Hacking v9

EC-Council

2017

Voice XML

C.a.T.s.

2007

Diploma in Information Systems – Software Development

Computer Training Institute

2007

Degree in Sound Engineering

Allenby Campus

2003

Matric

Capital College

2001